

HTML

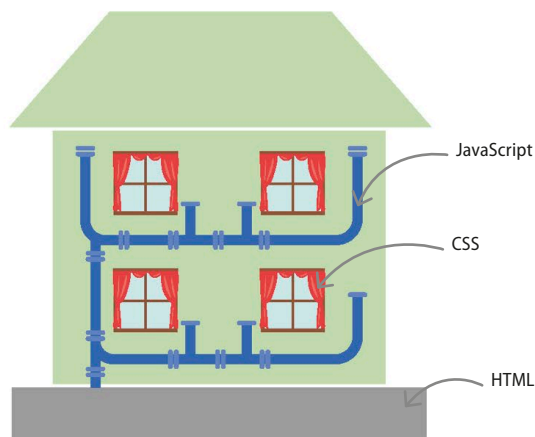
Hypertext Markup Language (HTML) is one of the three programming languages used to create every website on the world wide web.

Foundation of the web

If making a webpage can be compared to building a house, then HTML would set the foundation, Cascading Style Sheets (CSS) would take care of decorating, and JavaScript would be in charge of technical additions, such as electricity and plumbing. Each of these three languages is focused and specialized to carry out a specific set of tasks.

► Special tasks

Keeping clear boundaries between the three languages when coding a website is the key to making sure that everything runs properly. It is best practice as it makes the code easier to understand, but also ensures that the way the website displays is not a jumbled mess.



How it works

When navigating to a website, the server sends a bunch of HTML, CSS, and JavaScript code files to the user. The browser turns these into a graphic, interactive webpage by using its rendering engine. Differences in rendering engines might lead to small differences in onscreen displays.



Standards

To ensure that each website is properly displayed, the World Wide Web Consortium (W3C) created a series of international standards for writing and rendering web languages.

How to view the HTML of a webpage

It's possible to view the HTML of any page on the web. The HTML of bigger websites are optimized and can be quite difficult to understand. However, if smaller websites are checked, some of the details may be recognizable.

1. Open a web browser of your choice
2. Pick a website you want to view the HTML for
3. Right-click anywhere on the page
4. Click "View Page Source"